Abdullah Al Zahid

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SUMMARY

Transportation engineer with a master's degree and four years across GO rail service planning at Metrolinx and municipal transportation planning at the City of Toronto. Takes problems from scoping to recommendations, builds the evidence behind them, and writes the briefing notes and presentations that carry issues and options to decision-makers.

EXPERIENCE

Assistant Planner, Transportation Planning

City of Toronto | January 2024 – present

- Run assigned studies from scoping through to recommendations, writing the briefing notes that come out of them and presenting to planners, engineers and managers in other divisions.
- Coordinate with divisions, consultants, applicants and outside agencies whose priorities conflict, and work issues through to a position everyone can act on.
- Analyze travel and network data, including several years of the Transportation Tomorrow Survey, to establish where capacity falls short and what that means for future service and investment.
- Built the Transportation Data Dashboard, replacing a report rebuilt by hand each quarter with one validated source the division reports from, and saw the change through to adoption.

Transportation Planner, Simulation and Modelling

Metrolinx, Service Design | February 2023 – January 2024

- Ran OpenTrack simulations of GO rail services to establish what proposed operating and infrastructure changes would do to run times, reliability and recovery before they were taken forward.
- Worked with schedulers, operations staff and engineers on service design decisions and presented the evidence behind them.
- Built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and produced summaries of speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.
- Set up a command line workflow so temporary and permanent slow orders could be pre-simulated in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours.

Graduate Transportation Planner

Mott MacDonald | January – February 2023

- Short consulting placement on Ontario Line work. Ran traffic simulations to estimate how construction staging would affect surrounding streets, and prepared the supporting material for the project team.

Graduate Research Assistant

University of Alberta | January 2020 – August 2022

- Master's research on how road networks perform during emergency evacuations, using macroscopic (LWR) and agent-based (MATSim) models.
- Worked with large travel datasets and wrote up results for readers without a modelling background.

SKILLS

Briefing notes, reports and presentations for senior staff. Evidence-based analysis of options and trade-offs. Coordination across divisions, agencies and consultants. OpenTrack, VISSIM, Synchro and MATSim. Python (Pandas, NumPy), SQL, ArcGIS Pro and QGIS. Advanced Excel. MS Office.

EDUCATION

MSc, Transportation Engineering — University of Alberta, 2022

BSc, Civil Engineering — Bangladesh University of Engineering and Technology, 2018

BSc, Computer Science — University of British Columbia, in progress (2025–2027)